

COSIMO DE MEDICI

Cosimo de' Medici (1389–1464) oversaw the rise of the Medici family. His father had created the family's first bank, and under Cosimo it became more profitable and influential. He used his money to gain support from politicians for his various business projects. He also began the family tradition of giving financial help to artists. Having established the Medicis firmly in control of Florentine affairs, Cosimo paved the way for his descendants to rule Florence for many years after his death.



a family of bankers who rapidly increased trade and made the city incredibly wealthy. There were many rich people, who were able to sponsor talented artists.

So what did Leonardo, the budding artist, do next? Unfortunately, there is little record of his professional life in the first few years after his apprenticeship. Certainly, he was not invisible—he was known around town for his confident manner. He was also considered a good singer and musician. And it was hard to miss this handsome